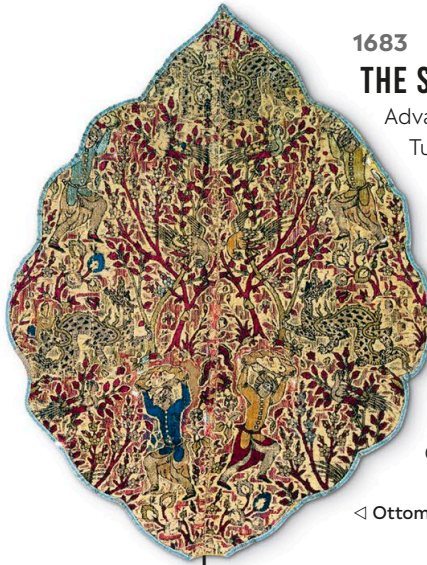




1683

THE SIEGE OF VIENNA

Advancing from Hungary, a vast Ottoman Turkish army led by Grand Vizier Kara Mustafa laid siege to Vienna, capital of the Holy Roman Empire. Polish, Austrian, and German forces led by Poland's king Jan Sobieski marched to lift the siege. Attacking the Ottoman camp, Sobieski drove the Turks into headlong flight. This defeat contributed to the decline of the Ottoman Empire.

◁ Ottoman tent panel from the siege of Vienna

1683 Taiwan falls to the Manchu Qing dynasty
after Taiwan-based Ming loyalists are defeated at the battle of Penghu

1684

1684 Shona warriors
of the Rozvi Empire drive the Portuguese out of Zimbabwe

▽ Cavalier de La Salle stained glass



1682

LA SALLE CLAIMS LOUISIANA

René-Robert Cavalier de La Salle was a French adventurer intent upon extending his country's territory in North America. He explored the Illinois River and in 1682 descended the Mississippi by canoe to the Gulf of Mexico. He claimed the whole region for France, naming it Louisiana. On a follow-up expedition in 1687, La Salle was murdered by mutinous followers.

1683

LITTLE ICE AGE

From around 1650, the climatic period known as the Little Ice Age reached its most extreme point in Europe. Frost fairs were held on the iced-over River Thames in London, advancing glaciers destroyed villages in the Alps, and widespread crop failures led to frequent famines. The winter of 1683 was especially notable for freezing temperatures and heavy snowfall. The causes of this phenomenon remain uncertain.

▽ Frost fair on the River Thames, London

